



1803

THE NAPOLEONIC WARS BEGIN

In 1803, Britain declared war on France in an attempt to curb Napoleon Bonaparte's expansionism. Austria, Russia, and Sweden were drawn into the conflict, and various coalitions of Europe's major powers were involved in a series of wars with France that ranged across the world from India to America over the next 12 years. After an early, spectacular British victory at the Battle of Trafalgar in 1805, the tide only turned against Napoleon in 1812.



1769–1861

NAPOLEON BONAPARTE

One of the world's most famous military leaders, Napoleon Bonaparte saved revolutionary France from destruction by its enemies in 1792-1802 and proclaimed himself Emperor of France in 1804.

1804 Haiti becomes a Republic after the last battle of the Haitian Revolution at Vertières

1804

1803 Mecca falls to the Wahhabi First Saudi State

1803

LOUISIANA PURCHASE

By 1803, France had lost interest in its New World possessions and needed to raise funds for its war with Britain. Accordingly, Napoleon sold the whole of Louisiana - 2,144,500 sq. km (828,000 sq. miles) of land between the Mississippi River and the Rocky Mountains - to the United States for the sum of 60 million francs (US\$15 million). The purchase doubled the area of the United States.

▷ Map of the Louisiana Purchase in 1803

